

The Ultimate Islington Weekend Guide

Your insider's map to the best food, drinks, culture & hidden gems

Welcome to Islington Experience!

Whether you're a longtime resident or just visiting, this guide will help you discover the best of Islington in a single weekend. From award-winning restaurants to secret speakeasies, historic theatres to peaceful parks—this is your curated roadmap to an unforgettable 48 hours.

▣ Friday Evening: Dinner & Drinks

Ottolenghi Islington Dinner

287 Upper Street, N1 2TZ

Start your weekend with vibrant Mediterranean flavours at this flagship Ottolenghi restaurant. Their colourful vegetable dishes and signature desserts are legendary. Book ahead—it's always busy.

Insider tip: Grab a seat by the window for prime people-watching on Upper Street.

69 Colebrooke Row Cocktails

69 Colebrooke Row, N1 8AA

End your evening at this intimate cocktail bar known for molecular mixology and creative drinks. No sign on the door—just look for number 69. Expect expertly crafted cocktails in a cosy, low-lit atmosphere.

☀ Saturday: Culture, Markets & Food

Morning

Chapel Market Market

Chapel Market, N1 9EZ

Start your Saturday at this authentic London street market. Running since the 1870s, it's a mix

of fruit & veg stalls, vintage finds, and international food. Grab a coffee and soak up the local vibe.

Open: Tuesday-Sunday until 3pm

The Breakfast Club Brunch

31 Camden Passage, N1 8EA

Fuel up with their famous all-day breakfast. Pancakes, full English, or smashed avocado—whatever you fancy. Expect a queue on weekends, but it moves fast.

Afternoon

Camden Passage Shopping

Camden Passage, N1

Wander through this charming pedestrian street lined with antique shops, vintage boutiques, and independent stores. Perfect for unique finds and gifts. The antique market runs Wednesday and Saturday.

Estorick Collection Culture

39a Canonbury Square, N1 2AN

Britain's only gallery dedicated to modern Italian art. Housed in a beautiful Georgian villa, it features works by Futurist masters and changing exhibitions. Peaceful, inspiring, and often overlooked.

Admission: £7.50 / Free for under 16s

Evening

Smokestack Dinner

35 Kingsland Road, E2 8AA (just outside Islington)

If you love BBQ, don't miss this. Slow-smoked brisket, sticky ribs, and inventive sides. Industrial vibes, serious flavour. Book ahead or join the queue.

King's Head Theatre Entertainment

115 Upper Street, N1 1QN

London's first pub theatre. Catch a play, musical, or comedy show in this quirky venue that's been running since 1970. Intimate, atmospheric, and great value.

Check their website for current shows and tickets

Sunday: Relax & Explore

Morning

Towpath Café Brunch

Regent's Canal Towpath, N1 2SN

A tiny canal-side café serving seasonal, simple food. Sit outside by the water, watch the narrowboats drift by, and enjoy proper coffee and homemade pastries. Cash only.

Open: March-October, closed Mondays

Regent's Canal Walk Walk

After brunch, stroll east along the canal towards Victoria Park or west towards Camden. Peaceful, scenic, and a completely different side of London.

Afternoon

Almeida Theatre Culture

Almeida Street, N1 1TA

One of London's most respected theatres. Bold productions, world premieres, and top-tier acting. Check their Sunday matinee schedule—it's a perfect way to end your weekend.

The Drapers Arms Sunday Roast

44 Barnsbury Street, N1 1ER

Finish your weekend with a proper Sunday roast at this beautiful Georgian gastropub. Quality British food, great wine list, lovely garden. Book ahead for Sunday lunch.

□ Bonus: Hidden Gems

- **Candid Arts Trust (3 Torrens Street):** Independent gallery and creative space showcasing emerging artists
- **Little Angel Theatre (14 Dagmar Passage):** Puppet theatre that's magical for kids and adults alike
- **St Mary's Church, Islington:** Beautiful historic church with a peaceful churchyard—perfect for a quiet moment
- **The Lexington (96-98 Pentonville Road):** Legendary music venue and whiskey bar. Check their gig listings.
- **Frederick's (106-110 Camden Passage):** Elegant restaurant with a gorgeous conservatory—perfect for special occasions

Getting Around

Tube Stations: Angel (Northern Line), Highbury & Islington (Victoria & Overground)

Buses: 4, 19, 30, 38, 43, 73, 153, 277 all run through Islington

Walk: Most of these venues are within a 20-minute walk of Angel tube

Stay Connected

Want more Islington recommendations?

This guide is just the beginning. Get weekly updates on:

- New restaurant & bar openings
- Upcoming events and live music
- Hidden gems and local secrets
- Seasonal guides and themed itineraries

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Your guide to the best food, culture, and experiences in Islington

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